The Noble Dhāraṇī Called Nīlakaṇṭha

Āryanīlakaṇṭhanāmadhāraṇī · Toh 905 · Derge Kangyur

འཕགས་པ་ནཱི་ལ་ཀཎྛ་ཞེས་བྱ་བའི་གཟུངས།

The Noble Dhāraṇī Called Nīlakaṇṭha, known in Sanskrit as Āryanīlakaṇṭhanāmadhāraṇī and in Tibetan as 'Phags pa nī la kaṇ ṭha zhes bya ba'i gzungs, is a short dhāraṇī text devoted to Avalokiteśvara, the bodhisattva of compassion, here invoked under the name Nīlakaṇṭha, meaning "blue-throated." After paying homage to the Three Jewels, to the Buddha Amitābha, and to the bodhisattva Mahāsthāmaprāpta, it unfolds as a series of heartfelt salutations to Avalokiteśvara. Each one is paired with an aspiration, such as attaining the eye of great wisdom, protecting all sentient beings, gaining skill in means, and boarding the ship of great wisdom. Texts of this kind combine devotional praise with the recitation of a dhāraṇī, a formula of sacred speech believed to carry protective and purifying power. This work is Toh 905 in the Kangyur, where it belongs among the dhāraṇī texts, the class of scriptures centered on such incantations.

In the language of India: ārya nīlakaṇṭha nāma dhāraṇī

In the language of Tibet: The Noble Dhāraṇī Called Nīlakaṇṭha.

Homage to the Three Jewels.

Homage to the Blessed One, the Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly complete Buddha Amitābha.

Homage to the bodhisattva, the great being Mahāsthāmaprāpta.

Venerable Avalokiteśvara, compassionate one, homage to you! May I surely attain the eye of great wisdom.

Homage to the venerable Avalokiteśvara, endowed with great compassion! May I surely protect all sentient beings.

Venerable Avalokiteśvara, compassionate one, homage to you! May I surely and swiftly attain skill in means.

Venerable Avalokiteśvara, greatly compassionate one, homage to you! May I surely and swiftly board the ship of great wisdom.

Venerable Avalokiteśvara, compassionate one, homage to you! May I surely and swiftly cross the ocean of suffering.

Venerable Avalokiteśvara, compassionate one, homage to you! May I surely possess the bases of miraculous power and swiftly attain the path.

Venerable Avalokiteśvara, compassionate one, homage to you! May I surely and swiftly climb the mountain of nirvāṇa.

Venerable Avalokiteśvara, compassionate one, homage to you! May I surely and swiftly enter the house of the unconditioned.

Venerable Avalokiteśvara, compassionate one, homage to you! May I surely and swiftly become one with the dharmakāya.

When I go to the mountain of swords, may that mountain of swords crumble and collapse of itself.

When I go into the pit of fire, may that pit of fire vanish of itself.

When I go on the path to the hells, may the hells be emptied by their very nature.

When I go to the world of Yama, may the hungry ghosts be satisfied of themselves.

When I go to the abode of the asuras, may their minds be tamed of themselves.

When I go among the animals, may they attain great wisdom of themselves.

namo ratna trayāya nama āryābalokiteśvarāya bodhisatvāya mahāsatvāya mahākāruṇikāya sarba bandhana cchedanakarāya sarba pāpa samudrocchoṣnakarāya sarba byādhi praśamanakarāya sarba ityupadraba bināśanakarāya sarba bhayeṣu tāraṇāya tasya nāma skṛtvā idaṃ āryābalokiteśvarāya taba nīlakaṇṭha nāma paramahṛdayaṃ ābartayiṣyāmi sarbārtha sādhanana śubhacetanaṃ sarba bhūtānāṃ pāpa mārga biśodhakaṃ

tadyathā āloke āloke āloka adhibati lokātikrānte ehyehi mahābodhisatva he boṅhisatva he mahābodhisatva he priyabodhisatva he mahākāruṇika mahāsmarahṛdayaṃ ehyehi āryābalokiteśvarāya barama maitri citta kāruṇika kuru kuru karmā sādhaya sādhaya bidyāna dehi dehi me raṅgamaṃ gama bihaṃgama siddha yogīśvara dhuru dhuru bīryante mahābiryānte dhara dhara dharendreśvara cala cala bimala mūrte āryābalokiteśvara kṛṣṇājina jaṭāmukuṭā alaṃkṛta śarīra lambha pralamba bilampa mahāsiddha bidyādhara bala bala mahābala mala mala mahāmala cala cala mahācala kṛṣṇa barṇa kṛṣṇa pakṣa kṛṣṇa pāna nirghātana he padmahasta cara cara niścareśvara kṛṣṇa sarba kṛta yajñopabīta ehyehi mahābīra mahābārāha mukha tripura

dahaneśvara nārāyaṇa rūpa bala bega dhari he nīlakaṇṭha ehyehi mahā hala hala biṇa nirjita lokasya rāga biṣa bināśana dveṣa biṣa bināśana moha biṣa bināśana nirmokṣaṇa hulu hulu mahā hulu hare mahā padmanābhi sara sara siri siri suru suru budhya budhya bodhaya bodhayāmi taba nīlakaṇṭha ehyehi bāmasthita mahāsidha mukha hasa hasa muñca muñca mahāṭṭaṭṭahāsa ehyehi bho bho mahāsiddha yogīśvara bhaṇa bhaṇa bācana sādhaya sādhaya bidyāna smara smara tvaṃ bhagapaṃtaṃ lokānupilokitaṃ tathāgatataṃ dehi dehi me darśana kāmasya darśanaṃ prasādhāya me svāhā

siddhāya svāhā mahāsiddhāya svāhā siddha yogīśvarāya svāhā nīlakaṇṭhāya svāhā bāraha mukhāya svāhā siṅha mukhāya svāhā mahā nara siṅha mukhāya svāhā bajra hastāya svāhā mahā bajra hastāya svāhā siddhi bidyādharāya svāhā mahāsiddha bidyādharāya svāhā padma hastāya svāhā mahā padma hastāya svāhā kṛṣṇa sarba kṛta yajño dhara bītāya svāhā mahāmāla mukuṭa dharāya svāhā cakrāyudha dharāya svāhā śadkha śabda nirṇādanakarāya svāhā bodhanakarāya svāhā bāmasthita kandha deśa kṛṣṇa jināya svāhā byāghra carma nibāsanāya svāhā lokeśvarāya svāhā mahā yoginīśvarāya svāhā sarba siddheśvarāya svāhā rakṣa rakṣa māṃ svāhā kuru rakṣa mūrtīnāṃ svāhā

nama āryābalokiteśvarāya bodhisatvāya mahāsatvāya mahākāruṇikāya siddhyantu me mantra badāni svāhā

The Noble Nīlakaṇṭha Dhāraṇī is complete.

Translator's Notes

• "Pit of fire" renders a term for a trench or mass of burning embers, one of the hell torments, set here beside the mountain of swords. In one of the homages the word for "compassion" is partly missing in the Tibetan, which reads "lord" in its place. It has been rendered "compassionate one", like the parallel lines. Nīlakaṇṭha means "Blue-Throated One"; the Tibetan title keeps the Sanskrit name and does not gloss it.

Colophon

This is an AI-generated translation from the AI Stupa project. It was produced by a careful, doctrine-aware process aiming at a high degree of accuracy, but it has not been reviewed by a human translator and may contain errors. It is offered as a provisional translation for those texts of the Tibetan Buddhist canon that have not yet received an authoritative human translation. Where a published translation exists — above all from 84000: Translating the Words of the Buddha (84000.co) — that translation is definitive and should be preferred; please consult it instead. These translations are released into the public domain (CC0) in the spirit of spreading the Dharma to all corners of the earth.

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.